Marvyn-Stephano Zalewski

Engineering Manager - Cloud Platform

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Summary

People-centric Engineering Manager with over **10 years** of experience building and scaling various **Cloud Platforms**. Proven outcome in driving **FinOps** excellence, achieving **$1M+** in annual savings, and modernizing **DevOps** cultures through **Team Topologies**. I bridge the gap between complex infrastructure and business outcomes, focusing on **simplification**, **observability**, and measurable **Developer Experience (DX)** improvements.

German citizen and eligible to work across the EU.

Skills

Technologies: AWS, Terraform, Docker, GitLab CI/CD, Github Actions, Observability (logs/metrics/traces), FinOps, Datadog, Cloudformation, Ansible

Security: SPLC, AWS Security Hub, Guardrails (SCPs), IAM Identity Center, Guardduty, RBAC, Risk Management, NIST, Incident Response, Application Security Assessments, highly regulated environments (PCI-DSS, ISO27001)

Programming: Python, Java, TypeScript, Javascript, Bash

Frameworks: Angular, React, NestJS, Next.js

Leadership: Team Topologies, OKRs, Scrumban, Coaching/Mentoring, Change Management, Cross-cultural and remote Teams, Stakeholder Management, Communication, System Thinking, Storytelling, agility

Experience

Engineering Manager - Cloud Platform, Awin Global – Barcelona, Spain Aug 2024 – present

Leading a high-performing, cross-cultural Cloud Platform and DevOps team managing the cloud platform strategy, driving DevOps transformation, and owning FinOps.

- Defined and executed an outcome-driven roadmap focused on **developer experience**, infrastructure simplification, and security that led to improved **DX**.
- Established and led the **FinOps** function, achieving **$84,000+ monthly savings** within 6 months across **AWS** and **Datadog**.
- Standardized the **observability** platform (logs/metrics/traces) by consolidating fragmented approaches into a streamlined system using OTEL and Vector that simplified the usability across **15+ engineering teams**.
- Following the team restructure, improved flow efficiency by reducing context switching and systemizing workstreams, leading to an improved **Peakon** engagement score from **7.2 -> 8.3** and **DX** score from **62 -> 73** within one year.
- Hired and onboarded **3 DevOps engineers** ranging from mid- to Senior 2 level across Spain and Romania to build out the Cloud Platform and DevOps capabilities.

Cloud DevOps Manager, Awin Global – Barcelona, Spain Jan 2024 – July 2024

Restructured team and operating model to remove bottlenecks and clarify ownership using Team Topologies.

- Analyzed bottlenecks, defined a new **department charter**, and executed a re-organization into **DevOps**, **Cloud Platform**, and **IT Ops** in collaboration with the Engineering department.
- Managed **3 senior DevOps engineers** across Germany and Italy to conclude the **AWS landing zone** and related infrastructure for further organizational adoption.
- Replaced Docker Desktop with open source tools and achieved **$18,000 annual savings**.

Security Architect, AVIV Group – Hamburg, Germany July 2022 – Jan 2024

Built and scaled a self-service Secure Product Lifecycle (SPLC) for AVIV's cloud-native products.

- Launched the **SPLC** and matured it into a self-service program (dynamic questionnaire and standardized risk reports) that improved application delivery times without additional headcount.
- Concluded **50+** application security assessments in 9 months and uncovered **80+ unique risks**.
- Reduced recurring findings by prioritizing platform-level fixes with implemented controls from preventative **SCPs** to automated responses and notifications.
- Raised security awareness across Product & Tech through an ongoing culture program (presentations, architecture guidelines, newsletter) embedded in team rituals.
- Established KPIs (**cycle time**, **completion rates**, **developer satisfaction**) and used them to drive iterative improvements and leadership reporting.

Security Officer Germany, AVIV Group – Hamburg, Germany Feb 2022 – Jan 2023

Delivered merger integration and AWS security foundations that improved control coverage and audit readiness.

- Ran the security integration stream for the German businesses, aligned controls to **CIS** and group standards, and facilitated internal audits.
- Developed and implemented the security stream for the **AWS landing zone** covering **IAM Identity Center**, a **Transit Gateway** hub-and-spoke network architecture, and centralized security logging and monitoring.
- Further fortified the **AWS** security posture via **SCPs**, **Prowler**, and **AWS Security Hub**.

Cyber Security Specialist, immowelt GmbH – Hamburg, Germany Oct 2021 – June 2022

Established the company's first cybersecurity function and embedded security and privacy by design into the SDLC.

- Improved cloud security posture via custom automation and **Prowler** scanning across **100+ AWS accounts**.
- Implemented and applied a **NIST**-based maturity model for the product teams and updated the **RCA** process to align with the product development lifecycle.
- Championed security culture with a company-wide **Capture-The-Flag (CTF)** program.

DevOps Engineer, immowelt GmbH – Hamburg, Germany Aug 2015 – Sept 2021

Pioneered a modern DevOps culture and rebuilt the main product with an AWS-native architecture.

- Modernized the legacy config management monolith by replacing **Puppet** with modular **Ansible** and introducing a temporary **Docker** platform based on **DC/OS Mesosphere** to increase stability and enable loosely coupled microservices.
- Managed, updated, and automated 3 Datacenters with over 50 Linux and Windows based physical servers based on KVM, Opennebula, and Hyper-V.
- Championed a **DevOps** culture and "You build it, you run it" model for an all-in **AWS** rebuild of the private property search, enabling autonomous delivery.
- Engineered **GitLab CI/CD** with **Terraform** (later **CDKTF**), including environment standards and **ephemeral stacks** to accelerate testing and releases.
- Developed multiple products in **Java**, **Python**, **TypeScript**, and frontends (**Angular**, **React**) to deliver customer value.
- Shipped the **AWS-native MVP** in **8 months** and completed the feature set **9 months** later.

IT-Support, Goodgame Studios – Hamburg, Germany Feb 2014 – July 2015

Provided IT support in a fast-growing gaming company while managing Windows Server infrastructure.

- Provided 2nd and 3rd level IT support for **800+ internal users** across two locations.
- Managed **Windows Server** environments, **Active Directory**, and later **Google Workspace**.
- Automated routine tasks using **PowerShell** and **AutoIT** scripts to improve efficiency.
- Developed and implemented a video streaming solution for company-wide events based on **Adobe Flash Media Server**.

Projects

- https://aiwods.live — **serverless GenAI** "Workout of the Day" app with personalized WODs, presets, timer, and reactions; built on **AWS** (Lambda, Bedrock, API Gateway, S3, DynamoDB, CloudFront) with a **Next.js** frontend.
- https://enabledby.cloud — landing page for my approach to platform engineering, DevOps transformations, and leadership; full site coming soon.

Education

tectumHOME GmbH, in Apprenticeship IT Systems Electronics Technician – Hamburg, Germany Sept 2011 – Jan 2014

State Trade School G18, Hamburg, in Higher Education Entrance Qualification – Hamburg, Germany Apr 2014

Languages

- **German** — native
- **English** — fluent
- **Spanish** — working proficiency

Interests

- **Cycling and Muay Thai** - Enjoy outdoor activities and martial arts for fitness and mental clarity.
- **Coffee** - Passionate about brewing and trained others on different brewing techniques.
- **Languages** - Enjoy learning languages to explore cultures and connect with people; currently learning Spanish.